TINA CHAO

User Experience Designer & Researcher | Human-Centered Design

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Professional Summary

A human-centered UX designer and researcher with hands-on experience applying design thinking, interaction design, and user research to real-world client, government, and participatory design projects. Skilled in translating qualitative insights into intuitive user flows, wireframes, prototypes, and conversion-focused digital products.

Education

University of Michigan School of Information — Ann Arbor, MI | Expected May 2027

B.S. in Information (UX) | GPA: 3.79 | Minor: Entrepreneurship, Music | Coursework: Intro to UX, Qualitative Methods, User Modeling, Web Design & Accessibility, Digital Product Design, HCI, UX Entrepreneurship

Experience

in2being — UX Research & Business Analysis Intern

Saline, MI | Jun 2026 – Present

- Planned, scheduled, and conducted stakeholder interviews with leadership and PMs at a medical device consulting firm, surfacing time-loss areas and clarifying ideal clientele — leading to redirection of less-profitable clients and more proactive resolution of client misunderstandings
- Independently initiated a business analysis — building affinity maps, a Business Model Canvas, SWOT, and competitor analysis — to identify clients' misunderstanding of in2being's value proposition
- Categorized recurring areas of client confusion and gave PMs and client-facing staff shared language to address them, driving better client education, time savings, and trust
- Delivered website and content strategy recommendations tailored to non-UX stakeholders; updated a statewide FDA-registered medical device ecosystem database

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Fourth Soil Farm — UX Designer & Entrepreneurial Intern

Ypsilanti, MI | Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

- Designed and launched a conversion-optimized e-commerce site, improving end-to-end user flow and reducing purchase friction
- Conducted user research and market analysis to refine information architecture, messaging, and flows
- Grew social reach 56.6K% and engagement 30.6%; doubled click-through rate via optimized landing pages and A/B testing

Projects

Argus Farm Stop — UX Researcher (Client Project)

Ann Arbor, MI | Aug 2025 – Dec 2025

- Conducted qualitative interviews and usability testing, applying heuristic evaluation principles to assess customer engagement across digital touchpoints
- Synthesized findings in Miro into personas, affinity diagrams, and journey maps, identifying friction points impacting conversion and retention
- Designed a CRO-driven landing page using interaction design best practices, informed by direct user insights, and presented prioritized recommendations to client stakeholders

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Department of Defense: AI Chemical Detection — UX Researcher

Ann Arbor, MI | Jan 2025 – Apr 2025

- Led 10+ in-depth user interviews with warfighters to surface pain points and operational needs in a high-stakes, accessibility-critical context
- Translated insights into iterative product concepts and low-fidelity prototypes; defined target users and use cases through stakeholder outreach and validation sessions
- Delivered capstone pitch and product strategy to DoD/DIU representatives through cross-functional collaboration

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UARTS FEAST — UX Designer & Researcher

Ann Arbor, MI | Jan 2026 – Present

- Spearheaded a high-fidelity interactive map prototype in Figma for a museum exhibit website, leading independently from concept to prototype
- Applied participatory design principles through cross-functional collaboration to support research on user engagement across museum exhibition contexts
- Supported iterative web feature development through research synthesis, reporting, and design documentation

Skills

UX & Product: User Research, Usability Testing, Wireframing, Prototyping, User Flows, Information Architecture, Design Systems, Accessibility (WCAG), Design Thinking, Heuristic Evaluation

Analytics: A/B Testing, CRO, KPI Tracking, Journey Mapping, Affinity Diagramming

Tools & Technical: Figma, Miro, Canva, Photoshop, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Python